

Welcome to FISH 290: Scientific Writing and Communication

Dr. Steven Roberts

Introductions

Who are you: your preferred name, pronouns, favorite organism, anything else you want to share

How did this course come about?

Let's be specific – **how will improving your scientific communication make you more successful?**

Getting your degree at SAFS/UW:

- Reports for upper-level classes
- Writing capstone projects

Getting into graduate school

- Writing letters of intent
- Emailing potential advisors
- Writing grant proposals for funding
- Publishing your undergrad research

Getting out of graduate school

- Writing your thesis
- Presenting your research
- Publishing your research
- Networking with colleagues

Getting a job

- Writing applications
- Publishing papers
- Public speaking / interviews

Being successful at your job

- Securing funding
- Publishing your research
- Presenting your research
- Teaching/Engaging the public

Capstone project

- This course is a prerequisite for your senior capstone project
- What do you know about the capstone?

Expectations

I expect you to:

- Attend each class regularly and on time
- Participate fully to the best of your ability
- Be curious and take initiative to discover new things
- Commit to learning and helping others learn
- Provide constructive feedback to your peers
- Adhere to ethical standards of behavior

You will have the best experience in this class if you **adopt a collegial and collaborative attitude!**

Expectations

You can expect me to:

- **Guide you in building your communication skills**
- Provide constructive feedback in a timely manner
- Listen to your concerns and respond appropriately

Grades

1. Participation (20%)
 - Attendance in class
 - Participating in group discussion and activities
 - “Weekly check-ins” – turning in assignments
2. Poster (20%)
3. Oral presentation (20%)
4. Written paper (40%)

Grades

Two parallel projects

- Choose a question to answer for a novel project
 - Basis for paper and oral presentation
- Choose an existing published paper
 - Basis for a poster presentation

We will make these choices in the first 2 weeks and stick with them all quarter

Syllabus

See Canvas

Class structure

Lecture for part of class

- In class activities
 - Peer review of published papers
 - Peer review of each other's work
 - Writing Sessions
 - Checking in with Luke about your own work
 - I will be looking at your computer screen. Google Docs is a good idea.

Assignment for Thursday's class

1. Formulate a question (or multiple questions) about the aquatic world
 - Sit in an inspiring place and think- I like listening to lo-fi music and looking at coffee-table books
2. Prepare to share your ideas with class next time. We will work together to refine your ideas into a testable question with hypotheses.

The choice of question is **really important**, because this idea will be the basis for one of two major assignments in the class. Your project will be solidified by the end of next week (with our help!).

Assignment in-class today

1. Write an essay on the topic below. *It will not be graded*- just to ease you into writing and help me sense where we are all starting from.

Write for 20 minutes (or as long as you want) then turn it in through Assignments on Canvas.

Essay Prompt: We live in a world where Artificial Intelligence text generators like ChatGPT can instantly and fairly accurately generate quality writing. They can produce things like research papers, cover letters, essays, and research proposals. Is it still important that I learn how to write well? Why or why not?